PROJECT REPORT
DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT
STUDENT DIGITAL AMBASSADOR PORTFOLIO

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INTRODUCTION

This project was completed as part of the Digital Literacy course (CSE0001) at VIT Bhopal University. As a Student Digital Ambassador, my role is to help my peers understand responsible digital practices, from building professional online profiles to staying safe against cyber threats. The digital world offers immense opportunities, but without awareness, students risk poor communication, privacy breaches, and even cybercrime. Over five tasks, I developed a digital literacy awareness infographic, set up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, Stack Overflow, and ResearchGate, explored collaboration tools by creating a Google Form quiz, drafted professional emails with a social media etiquette checklist, and researched a realistic phishing case study along with a comprehensive prevention guide. Each task was designed not only to fulfill the assignment requirements but also to create practical, shareable resources. This portfolio represents my commitment to helping my batchmates navigate digital spaces with confidence, responsibility, and awareness.

TASK-1 WRITE UP: CREATING A DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC

For this task, I used **Canva** to create a one-page infographic aimed at helping my batchmates understand what digital literacy means and why it matters. Canva's drag-and-drop interface and wide range of templates made it easy to design a visually appealing layout even without prior graphic design experience. I chose a clean template with a blue and white color scheme to convey a professional yet approachable tone.

My design covers three main areas: the definition of digital literacy, essential safe internet practices (such as using strong passwords, enabling two-factor authentication, and recognizing phishing attempts), and tips for maintaining a professional online presence across platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub. I used simple icons: a lightbulb for ideas, a shield for safety, and a briefcase for professionalism, to help viewers quickly connect with each section. Bullet points and short phrases kept the information scannable.

One thing I found interesting was how difficult it was to strike the right balance between visuals and text. Initially, I added too much detail, which made the infographic feel cluttered. I had to revise it multiple times, removing unnecessary text while ensuring the key messages remained clear. This taught me that effective communication is not just about including information but about presenting it in a way that your audience can absorb quickly.

TASK-2 WRITE UP: BUILDING MY STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

For this task, I set up or updated profiles on five key platforms that will form the foundation of my digital identity over the next four years.

GitHub is where I will showcase my coding projects and contribute to open source. I created a profile README (a special repository named after my username) that includes my name, branch, year, and a sentence about my learning goals, making my GitHub profile a welcoming introduction to anyone who visits.

LinkedIn serves as my professional networking hub. I filled in my Education section with my current degree, institution, and expected graduation year. Beyond that, I added my projects, featured work, professional links, achievements, a detailed skillset, and started building my networking circle. This makes my LinkedIn a comprehensive portfolio rather than just a basic profile.

Kaggle is my space for exploring data science and machine learning. I plan to participate in competitions and learn from community notebooks. **Stack Overflow** will help me engage with the developer community by asking and answering questions as I deepen my programming skills. **ResearchGate** will support my academic growth, allowing me to follow research papers and connect with scholars.

Over the next four years, I intend to use these platforms actively. GitHub will host all my major projects. LinkedIn will reflect my evolving skills, internships, and achievements. Kaggle will build my data analytics profile. Stack Overflow will document my problem-solving journey. ResearchGate will introduce me to academic networks. Together, they will form a consistent, professional digital footprint that grows with my learning.

TASK-3 WRITE UP: EXPLORE CODING & COLLABORATION PLATFORMS

Part A – Coding Practice

I created an account on HackerRank and completed the Python Introduction challenge. This involved solving basic coding problems that tested my understanding of variables, loops, and conditional statements. The challenge was beginner-friendly but helped reinforce foundational programming concepts.

Part B – Google Workspace Collaboration

Using Google Forms, I built a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" with exactly five questions. I included multiple-choice questions covering topics like phishing attacks, safe public Wi-Fi practices, and professional email etiquette, along with one short-answer question where participants reflect on their own digital habits. The form is designed to be engaging and educational for my batchmates. Responses are automatically collected in a linked Google Sheet, which makes it easy to track progress and identify common misconceptions.

Reflection

These tools will benefit me academically in multiple ways. HackerRank provides a structured platform to practice coding regularly, preparing me for technical interviews and advanced programming courses. Google Forms and Sheets will help me create surveys for group projects and collect feedback from peers. Mastering these platforms now will save time, improve collaboration, and enhance my ability to communicate data effectively throughout my four years at university.

TASK-4: DRAFTING PROFESSIONAL EMAIL & ETIQUETTE GUIDE

For this task, I focused on two aspects of digital communication: drafting professional emails and creating a social media etiquette guide.

Part A - Professional Emails

I wrote two emails following all professional conventions: one requesting an assignment extension from a professor, and another expressing interest in a summer internship. Both include clear subject lines, polite greetings, well-structured bodies, and proper sign-offs. These drafts are saved in the task-4-email-etiquette/ folder.

Part B - Social Media Do's and Don'ts

I created a checklist with 5 Do's and 5 Don'ts for responsible social media use as a college student. The checklist is available as social-media-checklist.md in the same folder.

Scenario: Poor Digital Communication

A real situation I recall involved a senior who sent a one-line email to a faculty member requesting a recommendation letter. The email read: "Need recommendation. Send soon." The professor did not respond for a week, and when the senior followed up, the professor explained that the tone had felt dismissive and that he had nearly overlooked it. The senior lost an internship opportunity because the recommendation arrived late.

What could have been done differently? A simple professional greeting, a clear subject line, a brief explanation of the purpose, and a polite closing would have conveyed respect and urgency without sounding abrupt. Taking two extra minutes to structure the email properly would have preserved the relationship and ensured a timely response. This task helped me understand how effective communication plays a crucial role in both academic and professional environments and how small mistakes can have a significant impact.

TASK-5: CYBERCRIME AWARENESS CASE STUDY & PREVENTION GUIDE

Part A - Case Study: Phishing Attack - The "Internship Offer" Scam

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a cybercrime where attackers impersonate legitimate organizations to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as login credentials, bank details, or personal data.

How It Happened (Step-by-Step)

1. **The bait:** A third-year engineering student, Priya, received an email that appeared to come from her college's placement cell. The subject read: "Urgent: Internship Shortlist – Complete Verification".
2. **The trap**: The email contained a link to a form that looked identical to the college's official portal. It asked for her college email password "for verification" and requested her UPI ID to "process the stipend".
3. **The moment of action:** The email created urgency by stating that the verification must be completed within 12 hours. Priya, excited about the internship, entered her credentials without checking the sender's address.
4. **The aftermath**: Within hours, her college email was locked out, and she received a fraudulent transaction alert of ₹8,000 from her linked bank account. The attackers had used her credentials to reset other accounts and initiate a UPI payment.

Who Is Targeted

College students are prime targets because they are actively seeking internships, scholarships, and job opportunities. Attackers exploit their enthusiasm and lack of experience with official verification processes.

Consequences

- **Financial loss**: Priya lost ₹8,000 and had to go through a lengthy bank dispute process.
- **Reputation damage**: Her email was used to send spam to faculty members, causing embarrassment.
- **Psychological impact**: She experienced anxiety, loss of trust in online opportunities, and spent weeks securing her compromised accounts.

Part B – Prevention Checklist

I created a "Stay Safe Online" checklist with 8 actionable tips, saved as prevention-checklist.md in the repository. It includes six general safety tips (verify sender addresses, enable two-factor authentication, use strong passwords, avoid public Wi-Fi for sensitive transactions, etc.) and two specifics to financial/UPI safety (never share UPI PIN or OTP, only scan QR codes from trusted sources). The checklist also lists the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and the 24×7 helpline **1930** for reporting incidents.

Reflection

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how convincing phishing emails can be. I always assumed I would never fall for such scams, but reading about Priya's experience made me realize how easily urgency and excitement can override caution. The email looked official, the timing was perfect, and the request seemed reasonable in that moment. This case showed me that cyber criminals are experts at psychological manipulation, not just technical tricks.

One habit I will personally change is **always checking the sender's email address before clicking any link**. Until now, I often glanced only at the display name. Now I will expand the email header to verify the actual domain. Additionally, I will enable two-factor authentication on all my accounts, something I had been putting off because it felt inconvenient. A few seconds of verification can save weeks of damage.

CONCLUSION

This project taught me that digital literacy is not just about using tools but about understanding their impact and using them responsibly. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I learned to create meaningful resources: from an infographic that simplifies digital safety, to a professional portfolio on GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, Stack Overflow, and ResearchGate, to a cybercrime case study and prevention checklist. I also practiced collaboration through Google Forms, sharpened my coding skills on HackerRank, and internalized the importance of professional communication. The most valuable takeaway is small, consistent habits, like verifying email senders, using two-factor authentication, and maintaining authentic profiles: build a strong digital presence. Moving forward, I will approach every digital interaction with greater awareness and responsibility.

REFERENCES

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